



SBI Life Insurance develops a document search solution with Amazon Kendra and generative AI, and streamlines call centers with a selfbot

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4 months

to develop the document search solution

30%

Hi, I can connect you with an AWS representative or answer questions you have on AWS.

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[SBI Life Insurance](#) is responsible for the life insurance services of the [SBI Insurance Group](#). The company creates and delivers insurance products that match modern needs. Using generative artificial intelligence (AI) capabilities from Amazon Web Services (AWS), the company built a document search solution to retrieve procedural documents on their insurance products and policies, launching the solution at its call centers. The solution also features a selfbot for quicker customer support and faster operator training.



Opportunity | Reducing Workloads of Call Center Operators

SBI Life Insurance, an SBI Insurance Group company, provides consumers with products such as an affordable mortality insurance plan, which allows customers to revise the sum insured based on their stage of life; a disability insurance plan that features multiple coverable risks; and a medical insurance plan that covers from inpatient treatment to home care. The company also offers group credit life insurance and group credit disability insurance to financial institutions.

The Information Systems Department of SBI Life Insurance is responsible for security response in addition to development, maintenance, and operation. From requirement definition to internal operation, the team continually builds systems in-house to streamline business.

“When it came to compliance or developing new products, our company tended to modify and use the existing applications,” says Toru Ikeyama, the head of Information Systems Department, Director and Executive Officer, SBI Life Insurance. “This approach created technical debt. We therefore decided to migrate our applications to a new technology platform using AWS.”

SBI Life Insurance needed to enhance customer service at its call centers and shorten the training period for operators. For example, the operators sometimes have to answer inquiries about discontinued life insurance products. SBI Life Insurance has products that were discontinued over 10 years ago, each with an enormous variety and volume of related documents, so answering these questions quickly was a challenge for operators. This situation made operator training a lengthy process.

Solution | Launching Intuitive Document Search Using Amazon Kendra and Generative AI

To help solve these challenges, the Information Systems Department started building a solution that let call center workers easily search for documentation on insurance products and policies. Initially, the team considered using [Amazon OpenSearch Service](#), a full-text search and analysis engine.

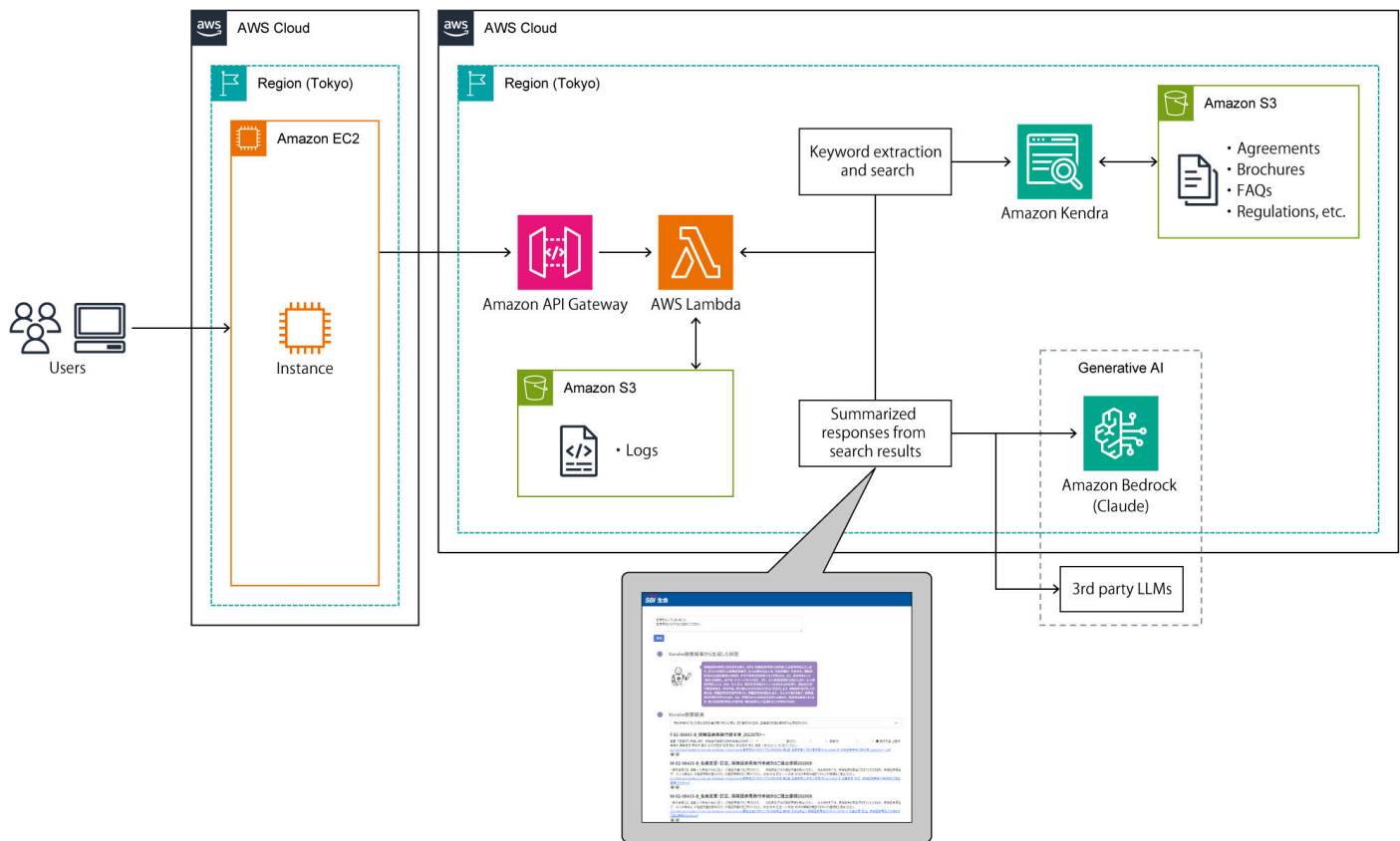
“We wanted to go beyond simple keyword matching and use machine learning to provide FAQ search results that reflected the user intent,” says Ikeyama. “However, adding these functions to Amazon OpenSearch Service would have increased development workloads and impacted the project timeline.”

In February 2023, Amazon Kendra, an intelligent enterprise search service, became generally available in the Asia-Pacific (Tokyo) Region. [Amazon Kendra](#) provides the flexibility to search for information in structured and unstructured content that is scattered across multiple locations, easily bringing convenient semantic searches to users who don’t have specialized machine learning knowledge. The Information Systems Department decided to build a document search system using Amazon Kendra at its core.

In addition to developing the solution, a key part of the project was to convert brochures for old insurance products and procedural documents for contracts into PDF format. Amazon Kendra uses natural language processing technology to read unstructured data in PDF files as a source. It crawls the source data saved in [Amazon Simple Storage Service](#) (Amazon S3), which is an object storage built to retrieve virtually any amount of data from anywhere, to create a search index.

The team started to develop the solution in April 2023 and released it to a production environment in July. “Amazon Kendra realized a development in a short period,” says Ikeyama. In September 2023, the team released a selfbot function that summarizes and displays Amazon Kendra search results using generative AI. The operators simply read the summary from the selfbot to respond to customer inquiries. To summarize the information, SBI Life Insurance employs several large language models, one of which is Anthropic’s Claude through [Amazon Bedrock](#), which is a fully managed service that offers a choice of high-performing foundation models from leading AI companies.

Architecture



Click to enlarge the image

Outcome | Shortening the Handling Time for Customer Service and Reducing Operator Training Time by 30 Percent

SBI Life Insurance conducted trials with a small group of operators in July 2023. As of 2024, almost all operators use the new document search solution. In the past, the operators had to search across various types of documents to respond to customer inquiries, but the new search system now empowers them to answer quickly.

The solution has significantly improved call center operations and reduced stress on operators. It also shortened the training periods by about 30 percent.

“What we want to achieve in the future is intelligent operations,” says Ikeyama. “Our goal is to automate and streamline comprehensive call center operations. The search solution is a part of that mission, and we will accelerate our digital transformation journey.”

As the next step, the team will develop a solution that automatically converts and summarizes customer calls into text. This will free the operators from manually recording conversations and let them focus on customer service, leading to better customer satisfaction.

These call center digital transformation initiatives aren’t attracting attention only from SBI Holdings Group companies but also from external enterprises and government agencies. Inquiries about using this project as a reference are coming from all over Japan. “The project has also boosted recruitment. Applicants involved in the intelligent operations projects have applied to our company,” says Ikeyama.

He anticipates that call center digital transformation will play a significant role in solving social issues in Japan.

"Japan's working population will continue to decrease, so securing labor resources is becoming a major issue. To solve this, we should automate as many tasks as possible and have workers focus on jobs that only humans can do. To that end, we'll eagerly use a wide range of useful services from AWS and drive the modernization of our applications."

About SBI Life Insurance

SBI Life Insurance is an SBI Insurance Group company. The company develops new insurance products and services that meet modern needs. Its insurance packages include mortality insurance, disability insurance, and medical insurance for individual customers as well as group credit life insurance and group credit disability insurance for financial institutions.





Toru Ikeyama

AWS Services Used

Amazon Kendra

Amazon Kendra is an intelligent enterprise search service that helps you search across different content repositories with built-in connectors.

[Learn more »](#)



Amazon Bedrock

Amazon Bedrock is a fully managed service that offers a choice of high-performing foundation models (FMs) from leading AI companies like AI21 Labs, Anthropic, Cohere, Meta, Mistral AI, Stability AI, and Amazon through a single API, along with a broad set of capabilities you need to build generative AI applications with security, privacy, and responsible AI.

[Learn more »](#)

AWS Lambda

AWS Lambda is a compute service that runs your code in response to events and automatically manages the compute resources, making it the fastest way to turn an idea into a modern, production, serverless applications.

[Learn more »](#)

Amazon API Gateway

Amazon API Gateway is a fully managed service that makes it easy for developers to create, publish, maintain, monitor, and secure APIs at any scale.

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HeyJobs on AWS

ITALY

The logo for Namirial, featuring a circular icon with concentric lines and a central dot, followed by the word "Namirial" in a bold, sans-serif font.

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